influence while he was able to take advantage of Russia's weakness. Curzon was a Great Game player by nature, and whether Russia was ruled by a Tsar or by Communists, the most important thing was for Britain to exert its authority in South Asia. After he had managed to conclude the 1919 agreement, Curzon cared very little for what happened to Persia. The country was 'a means to an end', not a legitimate end in itself. And when that agreement was wholeheartedly rejected by the Persian people, Curzon's reaction was simply to sulk. All of which gives an insight into Curzon's Great Game mentality. For the foreign secretary, Persia was a prize up for grabs. If he could not win it, he certainly wasn't going to invest his energy into the country for the sake of the Persians themselves.

So why did the Indian government appear so much more relaxed about the apparent threat of Bolshevism to Britain's imperial interests than many officials in London? For even though Curzon's scare tactics had not worked particularly well in regards to the Anglo-Persian Agreement, throughout this period Whitehall did appear generally more distracted by the issue of Bolshevism than Delhi did – surprising, given that for so many decades the Indian government had always been the ones obsessed about Russia's intentions towards South Asia. The answer is unclear. Probably it was at least partly due to the different intelligence assessments made by the Home and the Indian governments. Officials in India seemed to have greater confidence in their ability to cope with Communist agitation in the country, and their success at disrupting the work of M.N. Roy and his allies helped boost this self-assurance. In the post-war period there were also other concerns which appeared more pressing to the Indian government than Bolshevism. While Moscow was struggling to recruit to its ideological cause, the likes of Gandhi and the Ali brothers were having no such trouble. It was the hartals of the non-co-operation movement and the Caliphate Hijrat which were causing the real, practical problems for the viceroy and his men, not the bluster of the Bolsheviks and their incompetent fellow travellers.

In contrast, domestic labour unrest and disturbances such as that which occurred in Glasgow in January 1919, appeared to bring the Bolshevik threat to Whitehall's doorstep, while their intelligence reports only served to confirm their fears. The Indian government also seemed to have something